

# Coleson Weir

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## Fields of Interest

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Development Economics, Political Economy, Economics of Gender

## Education

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Ph.D. Economics, University of Notre Dame                               | May 2027 (exp.) |
| M.A. Economics, University of Notre Dame                                | July 2023       |
| M.S. Economics and Applied Econometrics, University of Delaware         | May 2022        |
| H.B.S. Mathematics and Economics, University of Delaware                | May 2022        |
| <i>magna cum laude</i> , Minors – Political Science and Theatre Studies |                 |

## Job Market Paper

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“Boundaries, Representation, and Local Growth: How Electoral Redistricting Shapes Political Candidacy and Economic Development”

*Abstract:* This paper examines how electoral redistricting affects political candidacy, representation, and economic development. I utilize India's 2008 Delimitation, which was the world's largest redistricting exercise, as a natural experiment. I exploit constituency-level variation in voter composition and changes in which seats are reserved for disadvantaged social groups. I find that the presence of new voters and changes in reservation status reduce both major party incumbent nominations and the probability of an incumbent winning reelection. Constituencies experiencing reservation status changes see an increase in paved road provision and higher nighttime lights growth in the five years following redistricting. As India's redistricting was conducted by an independent commission rather than incumbent legislators, these findings suggest that insulating redistricting from political influence can generate economic benefits alongside the standard justification of limiting partisan gerrymandering.

## Publications

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Weir, Coleson. "Education, marriage, and banning female genital cutting: evidence from Benin" *Journal of Population Economics* 39, no. 2 (2026): 28. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s00148-026-01172-0>

Iyer, Lakshmi, and Coleson Weir. "The colonial legacy in India: How persistent are the effects of historical institutions?." *Journal of Development Economics* 177 (2025): 103576. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jdeveco.2025.103576>

## Working Papers

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“Redrawing the Lines: Did Political Incumbents Influence Electoral Redistricting in India?” ([link](#))  
with Lakshmi Iyer and Susan Ostermann.

“Gender Quotas, Public Goods Provision, and Public Opinion: Does the Type of Quota Matter?”  
([link](#))

## Selected Works-in-Progress

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“Gerrymandering Gender: Electoral Redistricting and Women’s Political Representation in the United States”

“Dividing Lines: Redistricting, Race, and Party Vote Shares”

“Female Prosecutors and Gender Based Violence”  
with Haley Wilbert

“Free Primary Education and Intimate Partner Violence”  
with Taryn Dinkelman

## Pre-PhD Research

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Ardila-Mantilla, Federico, Naya Banerjee, and Coleson Weir. "Markov chains, CAT (0) cube complexes, and enumeration: monotone paths in a strip mix slowly." *International Mathematics Research Notices* 2026, no. 4 (2026): rnag004. <https://doi.org/10.1093/imrn/rnag004>

## Policy Publication

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“Retirement Investments: Agencies Can Better Oversee Conflicts of Interest Between Fiduciaries and Investors” (US GAO Report 24-104632)

## Research Affiliations

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| Member, Representation of Women Lab                       | 2026 – present |
| Graduate Student Affiliate, Building Inclusive Growth Lab | 2023 – present |
| Ph.D. Fellow, Kellogg Institute for International Studies | 2022 – present |

## Research Experience

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| Research Assistant to Lakshmi Iyer, University of Notre Dame | 2023 – 2024 |
| Research Assistant to Naya Banerjee, University of Delaware  | 2018 – 2020 |

## Teaching Experience

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|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| University of Notre Dame                      |                        |
| Instructor, Introduction to Linear Regression | Spring 2025, Fall 2025 |

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|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Instructor, Economics PhD Math Camp      | Summers 2024 – 2025                    |
| Instructor, Principles of Microeconomics | Summer 2025                            |
| Instructor, Development Data Bootcamp    | Spring 2025                            |
| University of Delaware                   |                                        |
| Tutor, Econometric Methods and Models I  | Fall 2021, Spring 2021                 |
| Tutor, Introduction to Econometrics      | Spring 2020 – Spring 2021, Spring 2022 |
| Tutor, Quantitative Macroeconomic Theory | Fall 2021, Spring 2022                 |
| Tutor, Introduction to Microeconomics    | Fall 2019, Spring 2020                 |

## **Presentations**

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- 2026 Gender and Representation Workshop (Representation of Women Lab)
- 2025 Midwest International Economic Development Conference (Univ of Illinois Urbana-Champaign), Notre Dame Interdisciplinary Research Symposium
- 2024 NEUDC (Northeastern Univ), Workshop on Historical Institutions and Their Legacies (Norwegian Univ of Science and Technology)
- 2023 International Atlantic Economic Conference

## **Honors, Awards, and Grants**

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| University of Notre Dame                                                             |             |
| 2 <sup>nd</sup> place – Best Oral Presentation, Interdisciplinary Research Symposium | 2025        |
| Kellogg Institute Conference Travel Grant                                            | 2024        |
| Kellogg Institute Conference Travel Grant                                            | 2023        |
| University of Delaware                                                               |             |
| Sally Latham Graduate Research Award, Department of Economics                        | 2022        |
| The Economics Graduate Scholar Award, Department of Economics                        | 2022        |
| Bertram F. Levin Memorial Award, Department of Economics                             | 2022        |
| Hutchinson Scholar, Department of Economics                                          | 2021 – 2022 |
| Carl J. Rees Scholar, Department of Mathematical Sciences                            | 2020 – 2021 |
| Charles N. Lanier Scholar, Department of Economics                                   | 2020 – 2022 |
| General Honors Award, Honors College                                                 | 2020        |
| Telkes Distinguished Scholar, Honors College                                         | 2018 – 2022 |

## **Service**

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Referee: *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*, *BMJ Global Health*, *BMJ Public Health*, *Economic Modelling*, *Journal of Development Economics* (x2), *Journal of Human Resources*

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| University of Notre Dame                                         |                |
| Graduate Student Conference Resource, Kellogg Institute          | 2025 – present |
| Graduate Representative, Committee on Sexual Assault Prevention  | 2024 – 2026    |
| Treasurer, Graduate Student Government                           | 2024 – 2026    |
| Member, Conference Presentation Grant Review Committee           | 2024 – 2026    |
| Economics Department Representative, Graduate Student Government | 2024 – 2025    |

## Computational Skills

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Stata, ArcGIS, R, Mathematica, MATLAB, LaTeX

## Other Work Experience

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Program and Management Analyst Intern, U.S. Government Accountability Office<br>Education, Workforce, and Income Security | 2021        |
| Research Intern, Wasmer, Schroeder & Company<br>Credit Research Department                                                | 2020        |
| Resident Assistant and Office Manager, University of Delaware<br>Residence Life and Housing                               | 2019 – 2022 |

## References

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Lakshmi Iyer (Chair)  
Professor of Economics and Global Affairs  
University of Notre Dame  
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Taryn Dinkelman  
Associate Professor of Economics  
University of Notre Dame  
Email: tdinkelm@nd.edu

Enrique Seira Bejarano  
Joe and Deborah Loughrey Professor of  
Economics  
University of Notre Dame  
Email: eseirabe@nd.edu

Susan Ostermann  
Associate Professor of Global Affairs  
Concurrent Associate Professor of Political  
Science  
University of Notre Dame  
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